implementing, coordinating and monitoring SAARC programmes. The Secretariat started functioning from 16 January 1987. It was also agreed in the Summit to extend cooperation on five additional fields:

(i) launching of South Asian broadcasting programmes covering radio and television;

(ii) promotion of tourism;

(iii) provisions of facilities to students and academicians;

(iv) harnessing the idealism of the youth; and

(v) jointly combating terrorism.

Third Summit: Kathmandu, 2–4 November 1987

The Kathmandu Declaration provided a renewed thrust and direction on the future course of regional cooperation. The Heads of States and Governments emphasized that a fundamental goal of SAARC was to promote the welfare of the peoples of South Asia. They expressed their faith in the UN Charter, commitment to the principles and objectives of NAM, resumption of North–South Dialogue, and recognized the need for special measures in favour of the least developed countries in light of recent decisions at UNCTAD VII. A major breakthrough was the signing of the SAARC Regional Convention on Suppression of Terrorism and the Agreement establishing South Asian Food Reserve by the Foreign Ministers of the SAARC member states.

Fourth Summit: Islamabad, 29–31 December 1988

In the Fourth Summit held at Islamabad, the Heads of the States and Governments expressed their concern at the high incidence of drug production, trafficking and abuse. The Year 1989 was, therefore, declared as the “SAARC Year Against Drug Abuse” in order to focus attention on drug-related problems in the region. The Summit welcomed the establishment of a South Asian Food Security Reserve in August 1988 and SAARC Agriculture Information Centre (SAIC). It decided to declare 1990 as the “SAARC Year of the Girl Child”. Further, it also agreed to launch “SAARC 2000—A Basic Needs Perspective” which called for a regional plan with specific